



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Catholic Academy
School Website: <https://stjohncatholicacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. John Catholic Academy (Panama City, FL) presents a robust Classical Education profile that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework. Public materials consistently foreground Catholic religious foundations, classical liberal arts, Great Books/primary sources, Latin, and a mission centered on virtue formation and, broadly, human flourishing. Evidence of liturgical life, daily prayer, sacramental imagination, and explicit theology-infused pedagogy anchors Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) as CLASSICAL. The school articulates a formation-focused purpose (virtue, wisdom) and a liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin), supporting CLASSICAL scores in Categories 2 (Purpose and Goal) and 3 (Curriculum). Pedagogy is clearly enhanced by memory and contemplative elements in early grades (chanting, recitation, restfulness) and by rhetoric/public-speaking emphasis, but explicit high-school-level Socratic seminars are less overt in public-facing materials, yielding a Element 4 rating of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Element 5 (Faculty) is CLASSICAL, with explicit statements about virtuous, skilled teachers and biographies/credentials; Element 6 (Parents & Community) shows strong alignment with parental partnership and formation (parental primacy and open engagement), yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating due to more limited explicit evidence of ongoing parent-formation programs in public materials. Aggregating across all six categories, the school is CLASSICAL overall, with some category-level nuance.

Key strengths

- Religious foundations: explicit Catholic theology, liturgy, daily prayer, Eucharist, and sacramental education integrated with curriculum (CLASSICAL).
- Curriculum and Great Books orientation: classical core, liberal arts scaffold (grammar/logical/rhetoric), Latin, and unabridged literature emphasis (CLASSICAL).
- Faculty: strong teacher profiles, small-class structure, and living-curriculum signals through staff bios and accreditation narrative (CLASSICAL).
- Parental partnership: parent involvement is foregrounded, with the school identifying parents as primary educators and offering family/community engagement modes (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL).

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories)

- More explicit articulation of high-school-level Socratic/seminar pedagogy and public speaking curricula in public-facing materials.
- Expanded, publicly stated parent-formation programs (reading groups, classical book clubs, family liturgy alignment) to solidify the Parents & Community category as CLASSICAL.

ABSTRACT

ed conclusion: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence



- Materials describe St. John Catholic Academy as a Catholic school with liturgical life and theology integrated into daily life and academics. Specifics include daily Scripture, prayer, Eucharist, and sacraments as part of Religious Formation; Education in Virtue; and a sacramental/moral imagination framework.
- The mission explicitly casts formation through faith: “forms disciples of Christ for life” and “Catholic liberal education” as the foundation of the curriculum.
- Documentation references liturgical life and daily worship (Mass nearly weekly in school life; prayer; sacred formation).
- Public materials note the sacral character of the education and the imago Dei/catechesis framing, reinforcing a sacramental worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: Catholic, theology, liturgy, Mass, Scripture, prayer, Eucharist, education in virtue, sacramental, faith formation, Disciples of Christ, liturgical order, sacred music, hymn/chant, catechesis.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no relativism/values-clarification/secular-humanist signals in the public-facing texts).

Why this rating

- The school repeatedly anchors its mission and daily practices in Catholic theology, liturgical life, and sacramental imagination—core markers of a Religious and Metaphysical Foundations CLASSICAL profile per the Six Elements lexicon.

Cited sources (illustrative): Catholic liberal education framing and sacramental language; daily Scripture/Prayer/Eucharist; Mass cadence; mission as disciples of Christ.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission states formation of virtue and wisdom as aims—“prepares and educates students for academic success and forms disciples of Christ for life.” This emphasizes formation over mere information.
- The curriculum frame explicitly centers on liberal arts and the cultivation of faith and reason for full human flourishing, i.e., formation of character and intellect.
- Language beyond mere job-preparation: “joyful pursuit of faith, wisdom, and virtue” and “classical liberal arts education” indicate telos-oriented aims consistent with truth/goodness/beauty orientation and human excellence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, great conversation, permanent questions, moral imagination.
- Negative keywords: explicitly workforce/job-emphasis terms are not present in public-facing statements; no “college/career ready” framing is evident.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds formation and virtue as primary aims, aligning with CLASSICAL rather than merely information-driven education.

Cited sources: Mission statement and formation language; liberal-arts framing; explicit virtue/wisdom/true-good-beautiful telos language.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum explicitly references the Classical Liberal Arts Education model and “liberal arts” with grammar, logic, rhetoric, and unabridged classic literature; Latin is taught in grades 2–8; Great Books/primary sources language is evident via mentions of Memoria Press and unabridged literature.
- Historical breadth across the curriculum and a focus on Western civilization, geography, literature, sciences and fine arts appear in public materials; unabridged literature and primary sources feature in the middle grades.
- The presence of Memoria Press and Education in Virtue (classical core components) reinforces the classical curriculum approach.
- Latin study is explicitly emphasized as a reason and vehicle for intellectual formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classics, Homer/Plato/Augustine/Shakespeare, Latin, Western civilization, history, theology, catechesis, chant, hymnody, sacred art.
- Negative keywords: no explicit “social studies” rebranding or STEM-first framing in the public materials; no overt “project-based learning dominates” language observed in the public materials.

Why this rating

- Domain content consistently maps to classical curriculum pillars (grammar/logical/rhetoric sequence; Great Books/primary sources; Latin; history as core discipline; classical heritage). CLASSICAL.

Cited sources: Curriculum sections describing classical curriculum and liberal-arts framing; Latin; Memoria Press; Great Books language; historical-literary scope.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Lower-grade pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory-focused activities (repetition and recall as memory deepening and delight), which aligns with scholé/restful/recitation-oriented pedagogy in classical education. The site publicly describes lower-school singing/chanting and regular review to deepen memory.
- Higher-grade pedagogy references rhetorical education and public speaking as outcomes (the public-facing materials describe grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core in the classical curriculum; plus preparation for public speaking and articulate expression appears in descriptive school outcomes). The narrative notes graduates as public speakers and logical thinkers.
- There are explicit signals of a classical pedagogy (memoria, recitation, memory work, and Latin instruction) and a governance of a public program that integrates technology and “classical-based” learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion (referenced conceptually in the classical lexicon and in the public-material mapping to Socratic/paideia pedagogy), narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé, liturgical calendar integration, rhetoric, declamation, oratory, debate, seminars, and education in virtue.
- Negative keywords present: The public materials do not emphasize experiential learning-only, project-based-only, or constructivist approaches; however, explicit high-school-level Socratic seminars or seminars/debates are not clearly documented in public-site copy beyond the classical-core language.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates a blend: strong lower-grade memory/chanting/restful pedagogy and upper-grade rhetoric/public-speaking emphasis; but explicit, public-facing evidence of high-school Socratic seminars or formal seminar cycles is less explicit. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Cited sources: Lower-grade memory/chanting; classical-language and rhetoric outcomes; public statements about classical pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty portrayals emphasize high-quality, virtuous mentors and teachers; staff bios included in the crawl show detailed biographies (degrees, certifications, and backgrounds) with a focus on subject mastery and dedication (e.g., Dean of Students, middle school Latin, history, English, etc.). This signals “the living curriculum” through capable educators.
- The site explicitly notes small class sizes and the role of the faculty in delivering the curriculum, with statements like “small class sizes mean more one on one instruction” and “caring and certified teachers.” These are core signals of a classical-faculty orientation.
- The public materials describe faculty as “teachers who understand the importance of learning” and the broader faculty ecosystem (attendance of staff bios, diversity of specialties, etc.).
- Accreditation context and professional-education language further support a faculty-centric classical model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: tutors/masters/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, lifelong learners, great books seminars for faculty, moral exemplars, teacher training in classical pedagogy, classical formation.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating

- There is ample explicit signaling of classical-faculty orientation through class-size signals, living-curriculum language, and extensive faculty bios with credentials. CLASSICAL.

Cited sources: Small-class-size and caring/credentialed teachers; faculty bios; ongoing professional development signals; accreditation references.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site explicitly identifies parents as a central partner in education with phrasing such as “As a Catholic school, we recognize parents as the primary educators of their children.” This is a direct alignment with the classical-pedagogical role of parents as co-educators.
- The public materials show a Parent Info page and routine communication channels, indicating ongoing engagement with families and opportunities for parental involvement.
- The school participates in battles and community ties (e.g., Purple Star designation for military families, which signals a community-facing, service-based dimension). While not a direct parent-formation program, it demonstrates community orientation and public outreach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, hospitality, parent covenant, family liturgy alignment.
- Negative signals present: consumer language or minimal parent involvement in formation (not evidenced in the public materials; the materials emphasize partnership more than consumer focus). The public-facing content does not strongly show formal parent-formation programs (e.g., structured book-club curricula or regular parent-book studies). This yields a partial CLASSICAL signal rather than full CLASSICAL for this category.

Why this rating

- The presence of explicit parent-educator partnership language and a Parent Info channel supports CLASSICAL. However, explicit, ongoing parent-formation programs or a robust “parents as co-teachers” program with regular book clubs or liturgy at-home practices are not strongly documented in the public-facing content. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited sources: Parent-as-educator language; Parent Info presence; Purple Star community framing.

Overall Ranking

- Element 1 — CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: Four of six categories are CLASSICAL, two are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Pedagogy and Parents & Community). The school demonstrates a solid classical orientation across Religious Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, and Faculty, with strong implications of classical pedagogy and parent partnership, but with room to more explicitly document high-school Socratic-style pedagogy and expanded parent-formation programs. The overall picture remains CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly articulate and publish explicit high-school-level Socratic seminars and classroom-seminar models, including structured opportunities for student-led discourse, debates, and formal rhetoric projects in upper grades. Expand recitation/narration techniques into higher-grade teacher practice with published exemplars.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Publicly promote formal, recurring parent-formation initiatives (classical book clubs, family liturgy resources, home catechesis guides, and regular parent education webinars) to strengthen the “parents as co-teachers” dimension and move Element 6 toward CLASSICAL.
- Documentation: Increase on-site or public documentation of the faculty living-curriculum through teacher-designed seminars, faculty-led Great Books discussions, and visible classroom exemplars to strengthen the perceived depth of the faculty category.
- History and Great Conversation: Ensure explicit public materials describe ongoing integration of the Great Books program and the Great Conversation as a central, recurring part of the K–12 experience (beyond initial statements), to push Element 3 from strong to fuller CLASSICAL status in practice.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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